

THE YIRT



Background

The Battle of Peth

At the end of the Clone Wars, the CIS Banking Clan Frigate, *San Nalaor*, arrived at a hidden CIS cybernetics research station “Outpost Peth” in the uninhabited Singla System. The *San Nalaor* had orders to evacuate the scientists and remaining technology off the outpost. Unbeknownst to them, Republic (now Imperial) agents had recently received the coordinates* of the research station. Not knowing the *San Nalaor* was in-system, two Venator-class cruisers were dispatched to the outpost to destroy its occupants and technology. When the Venators *Bulwark* and *Stalwart* arrived, they encountered an unexpected pitched battle with the *San Nalaor*.



The *San Nalaor* bided for time while shuttles from the outpost brought aboard scientists and equipment. The *Bulwark* pulled above Outpost Peth where the station rested upon a small, frozen planetoid (the only such planetary body in the system) and began bombarding it as the *San Nalaor* and *Stalwart* exchanged volleys of turbolaser fire. When the *Bulwark* dispatched fighters against the *San Nalaor* and bombers against the outpost, the *San Nalaor* responded. The CIS ship sent a large droid boarding party on a suicide mission against the *Bulwark* and turned all of its firepower from the *Stalwart* to solely the *Bulwark*. The *Bulwark* took a critical hit to its huge primary power core. The ship was doomed. While Captain Kritani, First Mate Ursol, and engineers attempted to delay an inevitable explosion, Clone troopers and a single Jedi Master-Padawan team fought a heroic delaying action against the boarding party as all remaining hands fled on any craft available.

**Republic agents had received the orders to destroy the facility from Palpatine himself. With Palpatine being the puppeteer of both the CIS and Republic, the cybernetics station had served its purpose and Palpatine wished to eliminate these assets and keep any advances in cybernetics wrought by the war for him and his cohorts only. A hydrospanner was thrown into Palpatine's plans due to the double-headed bureaucratic machine he oversaw – unknown to Palpatine a CIS admiral had dispatched the *San Nalaor* on its own mission.*

While the *San Nalaor* had turned its attention to the *Bulwark*, the *Stalwart* had caused it devastating damage. With any remaining outpost supplies or scientists destroyed by *Bulwark's* bombardment, Captain Harsol of the *San Nalaor* ordered a jump to hyperspace. The *San Nalaor* jumped to hyperspace and its treasure of cybernetics was never heard from again.



At nearly the same instance as the *San Nalaor's* jump to hyperspace, the captain of the *Stalwart* saw what he believed was the total destruction of the *Bulwark* as its primary core exploded. With all known survivors of the *Bulwark* already aboard, the *Stalwart* quickly jumped to hyperspace itself, in hopes of pursuing the *San Nalaor*. The *Stalwart* never returned, thinking the

Bulwark had been consumed by the explosion and after receiving more pressing orders soon afterwards (Order 66).

But the *Bulwark* did not completely explode. When its primary core went critical, the ship's two command towers, hyperdrives, and primary thrusters went with it. Much smaller subsidiary cores were left intact, keeping life support running, but the ship had been instantly converted into a stagnant space station with a single devastating explosion.

When the remaining ship defenders valiantly defeated the droid boarding party, they were able to turn to the next task of squashing the fires and secondary explosions occurring throughout the ship. It was not until a day later that they were able to rest and take stock of their dismal situation.

With the ship's captain dead, First Mate Ursol found himself in command of a dead ship with a small contingent of ship's crew, Clone troopers, and two Jedi. With the lost of the bridge tower, the ship's



** Years later, some survivors, would speculate the Jedi fell victim to Order 66 which was issued shortly after the battle. It was further speculated that the 2 Clone pilots must have been destroyed by the Jedi Master even when he fell victim to them. Other survivors concluded the Jedi left the Republic/Imperial survivors behind once they learned of Order 66. There are still some survivors who hold resentment towards any Jedi today.*

hyperspace transceiver had been destroyed. Due to the evacuation, the only currently hyperdrive capable ship remaining aboard was the Padawan's Eta-2. The Master's Eta-2 had its sled destroyed during the preceding space battle. All of the shuttles and ARC-170's with capable hyperdrives had fled carrying fleeing passengers. Two ARC-170's were left in a repair bay due to damaged hyperdrives.

After days with no rescue party, the survivors realized they had been presumed lost. The Jedi Padawan left in his Eta-2 to bring back help. Weeks passed and there was no word. A third ARC-170, damaged, was found floating in the battlefield debris and retrieved. It included a good hyperdrive and was parted out to restore one of the *Bulwark's* ARC-170's. The Jedi Master and two Clone pilots left for help. Again, weeks passed with no response*.

Surviving

The survivors finally resigned themselves to the fact they may not, ever, be rescued and took account of their situation. The ship's power requirements were greatly hindered. Shields, weapons, and the upper hangar field could not be kept on all at once. With only small subsidiary cores remaining, nearly all of the power was used for life support and general electrical use. Both the primary and backup hyperdrives were completely destroyed. While not all of the ship's sublight drives were destroyed, the remaining few could only very slowly move the gargantuan ship. When it entered the battle, the ship had a full complement of 9,400 crew and troops and over a year of supplies. The battle damage had taken a large toll on these supplies, but with less than 200 survivors, the marooned crew still had years of food stores; air and water were more critical.

The survivors began towing in wreckage from the battle, salvaging parts, food, and life support supplies. The outpost on the ice planetoid was found to have been destroyed by Bulwark's bombardment. Interestingly, a damaged shuttle was found floating amongst the debris that contained other survivors. The shuttle had been fleeing from the outpost in an attempt to escape with the *San Nalaor* when it was damaged, but not destroyed. Aboard was a group of entertainers that had been at the outpost* for the pleasure of a few of the upper echelon scientists. Two droid pilots were destroyed by a Clone boarding party. The shuttle passengers were at first imprisoned, but later released since all hands were needed to survive. The female entertainers would later be important to forming the next generation of the Bulwark.

** The entertainers included several Twileks, a Chiss, a musical band of an assortment of races, and a couple Rodian, "security". When they signed on for the entertainment job 2 years prior, they had not known their contract was a permanent one. Once arriving at the outpost they had learned of its secret nature and were told they would never be leaving again.*

With subsidiary cores providing power for years and large store rooms of packaged military foodstuffs, the primary concern turned to water and oxygen for survival. Below the *Bulwark* was a planetoid of ice dubbed "Peth" after the simple name of the outpost that had been upon it. Lieutenant Rutan and his band of surviving naval engineers set about creating an ice mining station upon the planetoid. The ice could provide needed water which in-turn could be "cracked" for an oxygen supply to help replenish the ship's life support systems.



Critical problems solved, the survivors adjusted to a spartan life aboard the *Bulwark*. With the ship's crew quarters and barracks destroyed in the command tower explosions, the residents made makeshift homes out of battlefield salvage within the ship's massive hangar bays. Repaired and reprogrammed CIS droids were made to do menial labor aboard the ship or at the ice station upon

Peth. After years of surviving, some joy came back to the former crew, Clone troopers, and once entertainers whom began calling their home, "The Yirt", since the broken *Bulwark* resembled this letter of Aurebesh in shape. The Yirtians developed a sense of pride in their ingenious survival as new relationships and even families grew from over 200 residents of the former *Bulwark*.

Contact

Eight years later, the first potential rescuers arrived. It did not go as dreamed. A ship of scavengers came after hearing an old tale about the obscure space battle. The would-be scavengers found a partially armed space station with several non-hyperdrive fighters. The Weequay leader of the scavengers realized they were outmatched and the treasure trove around the survivors was not theirs for the taking until he came up with a new stratagem. The Weequay made contact via radio stating they would not be taking back any survivors on their ship, the only hyperdrive capable one in the system. They announced any approach or attack upon their ship would have them flee the system. But, they could shuttle in supplies during their scavenger runs if Yirtians kept their distance and let them go about their way without fear of harm. The governing council of the Yirt reluctantly agreed. The scavengers began visiting approximately four times per year, each time jettisoning a large cargo container of supplies from a cargo hold they quickly filled with scavenged debris.



It isn't known why the next visitor came, but it was yet another scavenging ship four years later. It may have been simply someone else who learned of the battle site. Others believe one of the original blackmailers had loose lips or developed a conscious.

When the scavenging ship *Yiyar*, a ship of Rodian crew arrived, they contacted the survivors and agreed to shuttle them back to the closest port. Some survivors, including most of the Clones still conditioned to serve the Republic (now Empire) left at their first opportunity. Most of the crew, the previous entertainers, and some of the Clones with years out of service and quickly growing older, chose to stay with family and friends. News hit the holonets and an Imperial shuttle visited in 7 BBY, but saw only a derelict, old, damaged ship with some misfit survivors. Without any evidence of the where-abouts of the treasures of the *San Nalaor*, the Empire let the Yirtians be.

Those who stayed brought justice to the Weequay scavengers when they returned before the news of the *Bulwark's* discovery was out.

The Yirt began importing foodstuffs and life support supplies. A large hold of scavenged materials, droids, and armaments were sold, often much of it illegal. This made the usual trader calling at the Yirt a smuggler. This combined with the system still marked as non-inhabited on most star charts, led to the new port becoming a haven for smugglers. Hotels, entertainment, gambling dens, and warehouses for illegally traded goods sprang up upon the Yirt. Most of the new businesses catering to visitors were owned and operated by former survivors who suddenly enjoyed a modicum of wealth. Scavengers used the Yirt as a port of call even after the space battle debris field was picked through. More recently in 3 BBY, it was discovered there were some metallic elements of value if one dug deep through the crust of the ice planetoid Peth.

To this day, the Yirt continues as an out-of-the-way smuggler's, scavenger's, and miner's port relatively free of Imperial entanglements.

The Yirt Today

An adventurer may gain knowledge of the Yirt typically only from word of mouth. While its existence and location is not secret, it is not a true shadowport. Its neutrality rests in its obscurity.



Current Residents

The Yirt has a current permanent population of approximately 2,500. Visitors or temporary residents typically number in the low hundreds. Of the 2,500 permanent residents, approximately 500 are the original survivors and their spouses or children. The rest are, "Imports". The original survivors are considered somewhat royalty, owning most of the businesses and the station itself. Of the still living original survivors, 95 are regular male human beings being part of the original naval crew, 21 are of varying species having been part of the entertainer shuttle (all females were entertainers), and 38 are aging Clones that chose not to return to service (mixture of naval crew and troopers).

Government

The defunct leader of the Yirt is a 55 year old human Naval Senior Commander Ursol, the actual First Mate to the Captain which died during the initial battle and led the survivors all along. He is assisted by two aging (around 70 years old physically) Clones. One is the senior remaining Clone Trooper (was a Sergeant), the other a senior Clone naval crewman, an engineering Lieutenant Rutan. Along with other prominent survivors, these form an un-official voting council.

Security

Security is managed by the aging Clone Sergeant. He has a mixture of troops he has trained. They are armed with old Clone Trooper stores consisting of old blasters and spare clone trooper armor parts. A full suit is never seen but it is rumored there are some in storage in mint condition if needed. Security is backed up by aging oft-repaired and battered reprogrammed Super Battle Droids. A security patrol typically consists of a Chief, 2 Guards, and a Super Battle Droid under their command. Security administration is from a command post overlooking the hangar "Row" which was once flight deck control. Visitors will not have contact with the eyes



overlooking the Row, but will see a wandering AT-TE which has been modified into a mobile police station and patrols the hangar.

Typically crimes do not lead to imprisonment since the Yirt has no jail other than temporary cells aboard the Security Walker. Crime is punished through fines, deportation, or death.

Station Labor

Human or other-than-human “crew” are managed by the elderly Clone engineering Lieutenant Rutan. They are assisted by aging B1 battle droids reprogrammed to be labor droids for menial tasks. A large quantity of old astromech droids who were part of the old starfighter crews assist as technicians.

Vehicles

Battle damage, time, and selling inventory for needed supplies has dwindled the original fleet of vehicles assigned to the Bulwark.

Eta-2 Starfighters (2): Interceptors. No hyperdrive sleds.

V-Wing Starfighters (23): Primary patrol snubfighter.

ARC-170 Starfighter (2): Fighter-Bombers. Their damaged hyperdrives were repaired after re-contact was made.

AT-TE Walkers (9): 1 used by station security as a mobile police station upon the hangar deck. 1 is assigned to the Peth ice mining station as a patrol vehicle, but rarely used. 3 have been converted to ice cutters for the mining station. 4 are moth-balled and reportedly in prime condition.

LAAT/I Gunships (8): 2 are unarmed cargo mules used aboard ship by the station’s crew. 2 are unarmed transports used by a hangar taxi and cargo transport service. 1 is an armed quick-response-force craft used by station security. 3, possibly with some working armaments, were sent to the ice mining station to be used for transport and patrol (note that without assistance they can’t return to the Yirt which is in far orbit). It is rumored there may be others moth-balled by the station and kept in secret.

LAAT/c Shuttles (2): Two LAAT/c carriers remain. Both are currently used to pick up water and oxygen tanks from the Peth ice mining station and deliver them to the Yirt.

Transports: A battle scarred YG-4210 light freighter was the Weequay scavenger ship. It has been repaired and is now operated by the station. It is hyperdrive capable and used by station crew when needed.

The Port

The top doors of the Bulwark's primary, massive hangar are never opened. The fields to keep the old hangars in atmosphere would probably draw too much power from the station's power supply. If the top hangar doors were opened it is unknown if enough power could be drawn to save the denizens of the "Row" below. Rumor has it the door operation has been reduced to being hard wired to a secretive control panel only known to the top Yirtians.

Entrance to the Yirt is normally through the ventral hangar doors. Exit is typically through the fore doors. Ship traffic is required to move up high, near the hangar's closed top doors and thus above the businesses and residences below. If a large ship comes in, it can enter and exit through the larger ventral doors with traffic control's permission.

The two large port and starboard hangars are used only by the government of the station. Port is a warehouse of scavenged supplies. Starboard is a flight deck for fighters, shuttles, and other station-owned ships.

The Row

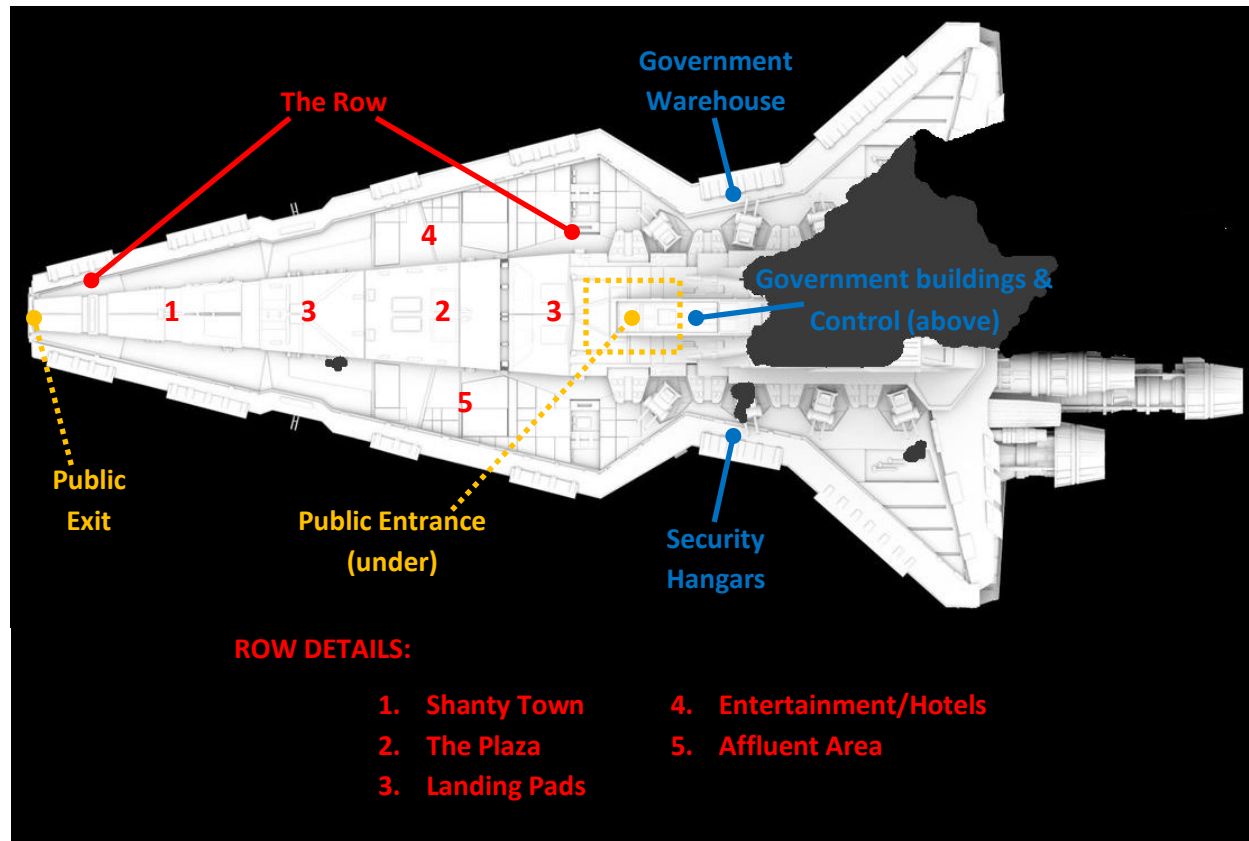
The life of the ship is the amidships "Row". The Row consists of the massive landing strip and rows of side hangars which once serviced the Bulwark's fleet of fighters and bombers. Today, the Row is a hodge-podge of businesses, homes, and landing pads constructed primarily out of scavenged materials.

The aft side of the Row consists of marked landing pads, especially for larger ships. As you go further forward you come to a Plaza of small shops and an entertainment courtyard. Beyond that is a cluster of marked pads for transport sized ships or smaller. Near the front of the Row is a shanty town often occupied by Imports.

The side hangars along the Row are rented or owned by various residents. Entertainment and hotels are near to the landing pads and shops. There are more shops in the side walls also. Adjacent to the Plaza is a more affluent area with residences primarily owned by original survivors. Government buildings are at the aft end beyond the hole created by the ventral

hangar doors. Above is a control station overlooking the Row. Small marked pads are interspersed at hotels or privately owned.

Many previous doors and passages leading from the Row to the remainder of the ship have been sealed to entry from visitors and residents. There are guard posts at the large passages to the port and starboard hangars. A converted AT-TE walker is the roaming police station of the Row.



Services

The Yirt has a large range of services available for such a small, out-of-the-way semi-shadowport:

- Entertainment: Seedy cantinas, restaurants, small gambling dens, and even elderly Twilek dancers!
- Hotels: From open air cots amongst twisted scavenged privacy walls to more affluent lodgings (for the Yirt) with private rooms.

- Shops: Gear, weapons, and cybertech, even illegal sorts, can be found on the Yirt. The problem is the Yirt is not a highly populated place. While anything (especially old Clone War stuff) could turn up on the Yirt, if you are looking for something specific you must keep your fingers crossed. Most shops are located near the Plaza, but others can be found throughout the Row.
- Offices: Both the Bounty Hunter Guild and Miner Guild have offices on the Yirt. Small, offices shoved in a dirty corner, but contracts and contacts are still available.
- Landing Pads: Marked pads with nearby warehousing of cargo are the most common, but repairs and more private bays are available for a higher price.
- Trading Venues: The Plaza is an easy place to find contacts for speculative trading of mined or scavenged materials.

Rumors

- There is a treasure of Clone Trooper gear in mint condition stockpiled on the Yirt someplace.
- The cybernetics research station was not completely destroyed.
- The cybernetics research station has evidence of where the *San Nalaor* fled to.
- The Yirt is completely hyperspace capable.
- The droids, not security, are actually in charge. The Yirt is controlled by the old ship's computer.